Raise a Concern About Your Wife's Care Without Losing Your Temper or the Thread

Four prompts to turn frustration into dated examples, work out who the concern belongs to, write a request that asks for a specific answer, and set up a record so the issue can't quietly disappear.

Where you are

Your wife moved into a care residence two months ago. Three times now you've arrived to find something that bothered you, and the last time you said more than you meant to at the front desk. Nothing has changed, and you're not sure what you actually asked for.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You can walk in with two or three dated examples, a named person to speak to, one clear request, and a page to write their answer on.

A one-page concern sheet: What I observed (with dates), How it connects to her plan, Who I'm asking, What I'm asking for, and Their response and next date.

Before you start

- Whatever you remember about each incident, with the day and roughly the time.
- Her care plan or the residence's service agreement, if you have a copy.
- The name of anyone you've already spoken to about it. If all you have is your memory and a lot of feeling, that's enough to begin.

PROMPT 1

Turn the frustration into dated examples

WHY THIS MATTERS

When you're upset, the facts and the feelings come out in one breath, and staff hear the feelings. Separating them doesn't make the feelings wrong. It makes the facts usable.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your account of what happened, written the way you'd tell a friend, feelings included.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> I'm upset about some things at my wife's care residence and I want to describe them accurately before I say anything else. Here is what happened, as best I remember, including how I felt:

> [PASTE YOUR ACCOUNT]
>
> Separate it into two lists. FACTS: each specific thing I saw or was told, with the date, time, and who was present, written in neutral words. FEELINGS AND CONCLUSIONS: everything else, including what I think it means about the staff. Then tell me which facts are missing a date or a source so I can try to fill them in. Do not add your own opinion of the care or the staff.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A facts list shorter than you expected, and a feelings list that explains why the last conversation went badly.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Fill in the missing dates from your phone, texts, or calendar, and check them with anyone who was there.

PROMPT 2

Work out what kind of concern this is and who it belongs to

WHY THIS MATTERS

One frustration is often three different issues: a task not done, a message not passed on, and a question only a nurse can answer. Each goes to a different person. If you believe your wife is in danger right now, this guide is not the route; call the nurse on duty or emergency services.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your facts list and whatever you know about who works at the residence and how it communicates with families.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are the facts about my concern at my wife's residence:
>
> [PASTE THE FACTS LIST FROM PROMPT 1]
>
> Here is what I know about who works there and how the place communicates with families:
>
> [PASTE WHAT YOU KNOW: ROLES, NAMES, MEETINGS, EMAIL OR PHONE]
>
> For each fact, say whether it looks like a care-delivery item, a communication item, a question that needs a clinician, or something about our family's own workload. Then list the kinds of people a family would normally take each type to in a residence like this, as general roles rather than names, and the questions I'd need to ask to find out who holds that role here. Do not tell me how serious any item is or whether it must be escalated.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Concerns that split into two or three smaller ones, each with a different natural home.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Call or email the residence and ask who the routine contact is for a family question about care.

PROMPT 3

Write a request that asks for a specific answer

WHY THIS MATTERS

A complaint invites an apology. A request invites an answer. The difference is one sentence at the end that says what you want and asks when you'll hear back.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The facts, the plan item they connect to, and the role or name of the person you'll speak with.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> I'm going to raise a concern with [ROLE OR NAME] at my wife's care residence. Here are the facts and how I think they connect to her care plan:
>
> [PASTE THE FACTS AND THE RELEVANT PLAN ITEM]
>
> Draft what I could say in about 150 words: a calm opening, the two or three dated examples, the plan item they relate to, one clear request (for information, a change, or a conversation), and a question asking when I can expect a response and from whom. Then give me three things to say if the reply is vague. Keep it respectful and free of blame, and do not include any claim about the quality of their care or anyone's competence.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A request you could read aloud without raising your voice, ending in a question that needs a date.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Read it to someone you trust and cut anything that sounds like an accusation.

PROMPT 4

Set up the page that keeps the issue alive

WHY THIS MATTERS

Issues don't get resolved or refused so much as forgotten. A page with a response box, a name, and a check-back date is the simplest way to make sure yours doesn't fade.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your facts list, the sorting from Prompt 2, and the draft request.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is my prepared concern about my wife's care:
>
> [PASTE PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Lay it out on one page with these headings: WHAT I OBSERVED (with dates), HOW IT CONNECTS TO HER PLAN, WHO I'M ASKING, WHAT I'M ASKING FOR, and THEIR RESPONSE AND NEXT DATE. Leave the last section blank with space for the date, the person's name, what they said, what they committed to, and the date I'll check back. Add a line at the bottom that reads STATUS: OPEN. Do not suggest what to do if they don't respond; I'll bring that question to our care consultant.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A page with more blank space than text. The blanks get filled in after the conversation, and that's the point.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Take it to the conversation, write the response on it before you leave the building, and keep it dated.

Put the concern next to the whole picture

A concern is easier to raise, and easier for staff to hear, when it sits beside a clear description of who your wife is and what she needs. The care interview builds that description into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›